

Sheng Zhao

CONTACT INFORMATION

Ph.D. Student
Department of Computer Science
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Seeking Summer 2027 Internship in the U.S. (Research-Oriented / Applied-Oriented)
The Ph.D. program at the University of Rochester supports Curricular Practical Training (CPT) for internships.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am interested in vision (computer vision and human vision) and deep learning, specifically (1) interpretable and generative models of human perception, cognition, and behavior, and (2) training and learning dynamics of large language models.

EDUCATION

University of Rochester, Rochester, NY, USA
Ph.D., Computer Science
Advisor: [Yuhao Zhu](#)

Jan 2026 – present

Tsinghua University, Beijing, China
B.S., Mathematics and Physics
B.Eng., Electrical Engineering (dual degree)

Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

INDUSTRIAL INTERSHIPS

ByteDance, Beijing, China
Intern, AI Coding Team

Oct 2025 – Jan 2026

Topics: Improving the front-end coding capabilities of agentic models (Seed-1.6-Code, etc.) via post-training (SFT and RL).

Z.ai (Zhipu AI), Beijing, China
Intern, GLM Team

Mar 2025 – Jul 2025

Topics: Improving the GUI web-agent capabilities of [GLM-4.5V](#) through data synthesis, distillation, and post-training (SFT).

SELECTED PAPERS

* denotes equal contribution.

- [Sheng Zhao, Yuhao Zhu](#)
[“Specialists Learn Faster: Knowledge Organization in Pre-training Shapes Knowledge Update Efficiency”](#)
[Under Review]
- [Sheng Zhao, Weikai Lin, Yuhao Zhu](#)
[“GazeFlow: From Human Gaze Behavior to Generative Egocentric Gaze Prediction”](#)
[[NeurIPS 2026](#)] *40th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems*

ALL
PUBLICATIONS

- Sheng Zhao, Weikai Lin, Yuhao Zhu
[“Multidimensional Observer Model and Perceptual Dimensions of Human Image Quality Assessment”](#)
[NeurIPS 2026] 40th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems
- Sheng Zhao*, Junrui Zhu*, Shuning Zhang, Xueyang Wang, Hongyi Li, Fang Yi, Xin Yi, Hewu Li
[“CoordAuth: Hands-Free Two-Factor Authentication in Virtual Reality Leveraging Head-Eye Coordination”](#)
[IEEE VR 2025] 32nd IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces
- Sheng Zhao, Weikai Lin, Yuhao Zhu
[“GazeFlow: From Human Gaze Behavior to Generative Egocentric Gaze Prediction”](#)
[NeurIPS 2026] 40th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems
- Sheng Zhao, Weikai Lin, Yuhao Zhu
[“Multidimensional Observer Model and Perceptual Dimensions of Human Image Quality Assessment”](#)
[NeurIPS 2026] 40th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems
- Weikai Lin, Sheng Zhao, Ian Ross, Carl Marshall, Sushant Kondguli, Yuhao Zhu
[“LowPowAR: Power-Constrained Tone Mapping for Augmented Reality”](#)
[TVCG 2026] IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (ISMAR Journal Track)
- Sheng Zhao*, Junrui Zhu*, Shuning Zhang, Xueyang Wang, Hongyi Li, Fang Yi, Xin Yi, Hewu Li
[“CoordAuth: Hands-Free Two-Factor Authentication in Virtual Reality Leveraging Head-Eye Coordination”](#)
[IEEE VR 2025] 32nd IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces
- Xueyang Wang, Sheng Zhao, Yihe Wang, Ziyu Han, Xinge Liu, Xin Tong, Xin Yi
[“Raise Your Eyebrows Higher: Facilitating Emotional Communication in Social Virtual Reality Through Region-specific Facial Expression Scaling”](#)
[CHI 2025] ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems
- Janet Johnson, Macarena Peralta, Mansanjam Kaur, Sophia Huang, Sheng Zhao, Hannah Guan, Shwetha Rajaram, Michael Nebeling
[“Exploring Collaborative GenAI Agents in Synchronous Group Settings: Eliciting Team Perceptions and Design Considerations for the Future of Work”](#)
[CSCW 2025] 28th ACM SIGCHI Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work & Social Computing

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Rochester, Rochester, NY, USA

Graduate Researcher

Jan 2026 – present

Advisor: [Yuhao Zhu](#).

Topics: Vision and deep learning.

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, Ann Arbor, MI, USA

Research Assistant

Jun 2024 – Sep 2024

Advisor: [Michael Nebeling](#).

Topics: Collaborative generative AI agents in synchronous group settings.

University of Rochester, Remote

Research Assistant

Jan 2024 – Sep 2024

Advisor: [Yukang Yan](#).

Topics: Conversational strategies and multi-agent settings for emotional support.

Tsinghua University, Beijing, China

Research Assistant

Nov 2023 – Jun 2024

Advisor: [Bowen Zhou](#).

Topics: Single-image-guided 3D diffusion for novel view synthesis.

Tsinghua University, Beijing, China

Research Assistant

Apr 2023 – Jun 2024

Advisor: [Xin Yi](#).

Topics: Authentication in VR and facial expression scaling in social VR.

EXTERNAL SERVICE

Reviewer

- CHI: 2025, 2026
- IEEE VR: 2025, 2026, 2027
- ISMAR: 2025
- DIS: 2025
- IMWUT: 2024
- ICWSM: 2025

Student Volunteer

- CHI: 2025

SKILLS

Programming: Python, PyTorch, C, C#, MATLAB, Verilog

Languages: Mandarin (native), English (TOEFL 103)